

Community Information Session

Land Use / Master Plans / Affordable Housing

General Structure of this Meeting

5:30 - 6pm: Introductions and Overview

6 - 6:45pm: Presentation

6:45 - 7pm: Q&A

7 - 7:30pm: Closing and Discussion

Who are we?

Our Mission

We are an internship initiative working with the District 2 Cobb County Commissioner's office. We are seeking to better understand the challenges of housing and the barriers to affordable housing here in Cobb county.



Our Goal

Our team is focused on collecting information and engaging the community to build better land-use and housing plans

What is Affordable Housing?

It Is...

- **Accessible** - options for individuals across various income levels with focus on low and moderate-income households
- **Safe** - a secure and healthy living environment that meets basic safety standards
- **Sustainable** - Built with long-term quality and energy-efficient practices to reduce costs for residents
- **Inclusive** - housing for people from diverse backgrounds and mixed-income communities
- **Supportive** - Often includes resources like job training, childcare, or healthcare to help residents thrive

It is not...

- **Temporary** - Unlike short-term shelters, it's designed for stable, long-term residency
- **Isolated** - Shouldn't be placed far from essential services, schools, and job opportunities
- **Low-Quality** - housing maintains quality and safety
- **Uniform** - Isn't one-size-fits-all; comes in diverse forms to suit different family sizes and needs

What is Zoning?

Zoning is the legal framework that regulates land use and building development. The agreed-upon uses of land.

Key Components

District Types

R-80: Single-family residential with a lot size of 80,000 sq ft
R-40: Single-family residential with a lot size of 40,000 sq ft
R-30: Single-family residential with a lot size of 30,000 sq ft
R-20: Single-family residential with a lot size of 20,000 sq ft
R-15: Single-family residential with a lot size of 15,000 sq ft
R-12: Single-family residential with a lot size of 12,000 sq ft
RD: Residential duplex
RA-4: Single-family attached/detached residential
SC: Suburban condominium residential district
RM-8: Residential multifamily
FST: Fee simple townhouse residential
GC: General commercial district for retail and service uses

Development Standards

Building Height
Setbacks
Density
Parking Requirements
Etc

Note: these can be different for each district

Zoning Affects... Property Values, Neighborhood Character and dynamic,
Business Location, Housing Options..

What are Civic Organizations? What Role Do They Have?

- Civic organizations are the foundation of this country! They're "clubs" with a purpose!
- Examples like PFCA, ECCA, MIC, etc
 - Neighborhood Associations
 - Business Groups
 - Advocacy Organizations
 - Religious Institutions
 - Educational Partners

Critical Role Connecting The Community



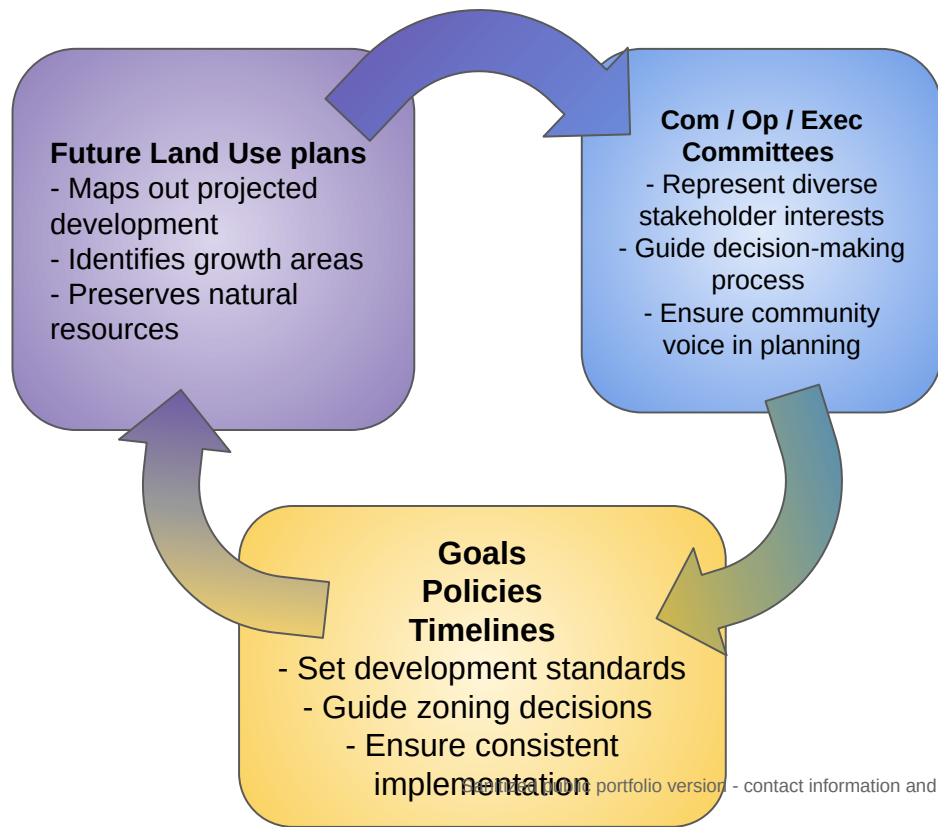
What is Land-Use and Comprehensive Planning?

Land Use / Comprehensive planning guides the growth of the coming decades in a way that provides for the enhancement of existing neighborhoods, commercial nodes, corridors, and job centers. This creates predictability, crafts a vision for the future, and seeks potential opportunities for the people / area



Why plan? How Does This Affect Me?

These types of plans help to ensure the County can meet future population and employment demands and preserve the existing character of the distinct areas, neighborhoods, and communities



The Goal? Why Should I Care?

To seek a balance through quality redevelopment, new greenfield development, and the preservation of stable suburban neighborhoods

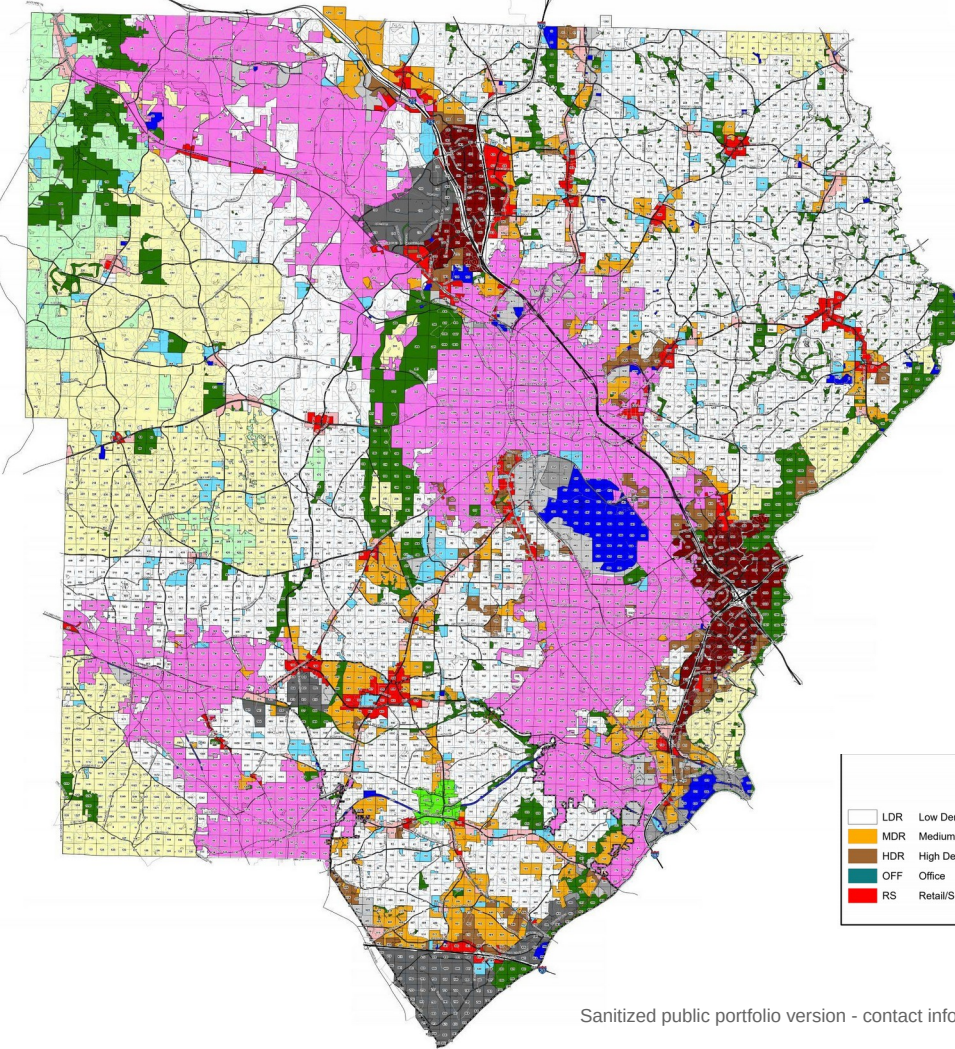
What are the main parts of a Land-Use and/or Master Plan / Comprehensive Plan?

- Summary & Vision Statement
- Data & Demographics Research & Analysis of Existing Conditions
- Land Use and Zoning Maps (may include Future Land Use)
- Various Topics
- Transportation, Housing, Community Facilities, Environment & Natural Resources
- Implementation Strategy
- Public Input, Engagement Documentation, and Supporting Docs
- Maps and Technical Appendices

Summary of Existing Land Use & Master Planning Docs

Led By / For	Name of Doc	Date	Includes FLUM?
City of Acworth	2022 City of Acworth Comprehensive Plan	Aug 2022	Yes
City of Austell	City of Austell 2022 Comprehensive Plan	Nov 2022	Not Found
City of Kennesaw	City of Kennesaw 2022 Comprehensive Plan	June 2022	Yes
City of Marietta	City of Marietta 2022 Comprehensive Plan	Oct 2022	Yes
City of Powder Springs	Springs in Motion Comprehensive Plan Update	Dec 2021	Yes
City of Smyrna	8 Guide Smyrna 2040 Comprehensive Plan	Jan 2023	Yes
To be continued	To be continued	N/A	N/A

Cobb Future Land Use Map (Jan 2024 version)



Legend

- Historic District
- Railroad
- Stream
- Lake
- City of Mableton

Regional Activity Center (RAC) Sub-Categories

- | | |
|--|---|
| LDR Low Density Residential | IND Industrial |
| MDR Medium Density Residential | TCU Transportation/Communication/Utilities |
| HDR High Density Residential | PI Public Institution |
| OFF Office | OSR Open-Space/Recreation |
| RS Retail/Service | TZ Transition Zone |

FUTURE LAND USE LEGEND

- | | |
|---|---|
| RR | Rural Residential |
| VLDR | Very Low Density Residential |
| LDR | Low Density Residential |
| MDR | Medium Density Residential |
| HDR | High Density Residential |
| NAC | Neighborhood Activity Center |
| CAC | Community Activity Center |
| RAC | Regional Activity Center (Note: Sub-Categories) |
| IC | Industrial Compatible |
| IND | Industrial |
| PIA | Priority Industrial Area |
| TCU | Transportation/Communication/Utilities |
| PRC | Park/Recreation/Conservation |
| PI | Public Institutional |
| MTC | Mableton Town Center |
| CTY | City (Note: Excluding Mableton) |

The Future Land Use Map does not categorize any land as Undeveloped or Agriculture/Forestry; development is anticipated throughout the county.

FLUM - RAC

FUTURE LAND USE LEGEND

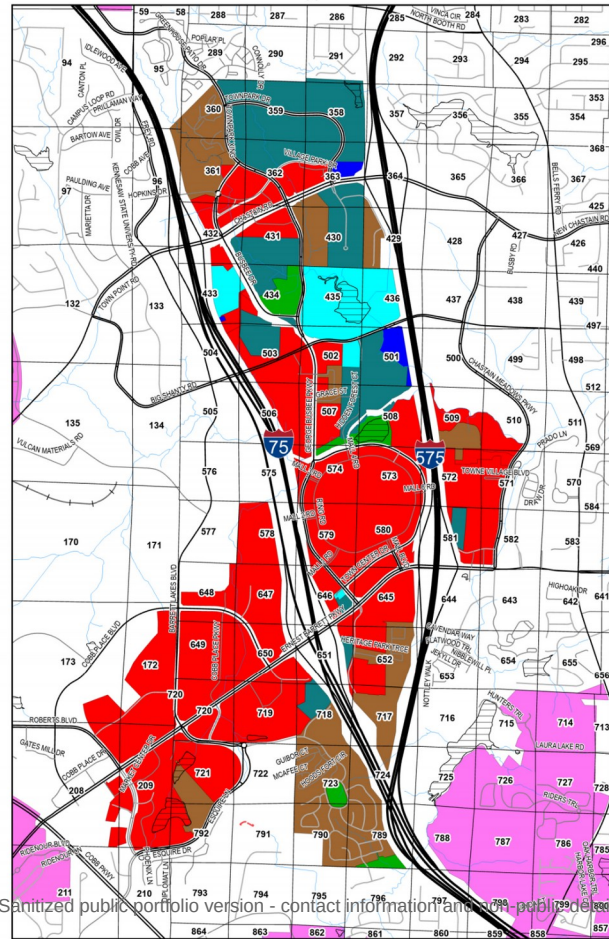
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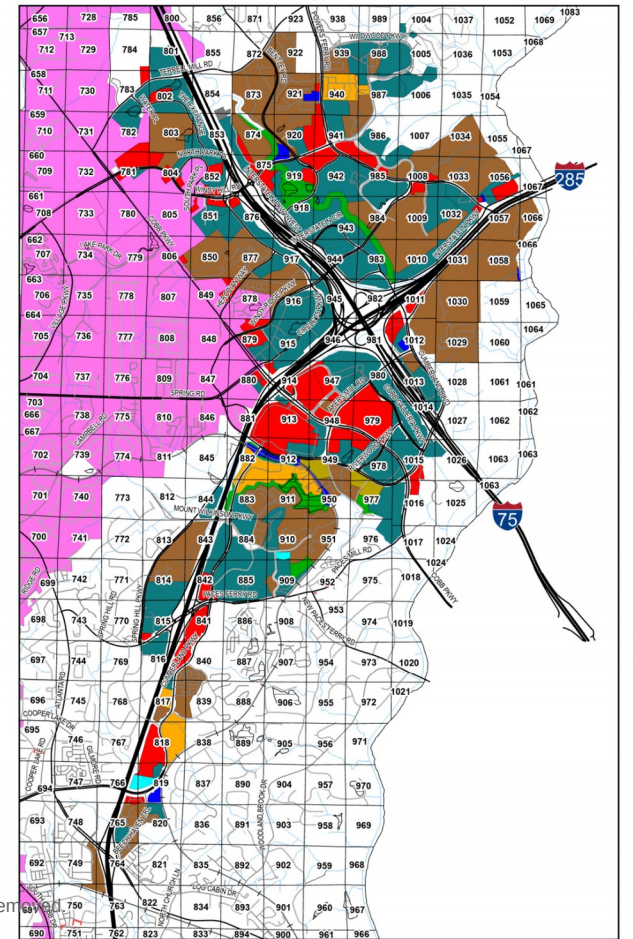
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Town Center Mall Regional Activity Center Sub-Categories



Cumberland Galleria Regional Activity Center Sub-Categories



Proposed Timeline Example

Phase 1: Initial Launch (Q4 2024)

Today (11/19/2024): Community Information Session
December 2024: Document / Website Release - Proposed Plan & Timeline + Community Portal
Community Feedback Period Opens Online

Phase 2: Foundation Building (Q1 2025)

January: Community Workshop #1 - Vision & Priorities
February: Community Workshop #2 - Strategy Development
February: Non-profit Formation
Ongoing: Digital Survey & Online Engagement

Phase 3: Development (Q2-Q3 2025)

March-May: Research, Analysis, Documentation Updates
May: Community Workshop #3 - Topic TBD
Community Input Integration
Draft Plan Development

Phase 4: Refinement & Approval (Q4 2025)

September: Draft Plan Public Review / Community Workshop #4
October: "Final" Community Input Session
November: Plan Revisions / 2nd public hearing
December: Present to Board of Commissioners

Key to Success

Passage of updated Land-Use / Comprehensive Plans

Minimum 3 Community Engagement Sessions

500+ Community Survey Responses

Digital Platform for Ongoing Feedback

Quarterly Progress Reports

Proposed Non-profit and Structure Example

What is the point of this non-profit vs others or other civic organizations?

Different than appointed planning commission members...and similar to democratically elected board of commissioners.

What is the main task / purpose of this potential non-profit?

Connect residents outside of traditional civic organizations to the planning process and to connect civic organizations to the county and the residents that live here.

How is this any different?

It creates more specific planning groups that are elected with the purpose to work-together to achieve hyper-local, community, and county goals

Questions and Discussion

This is a sanitized public portfolio version of the community information session.

Original contact information and non-public working details have been removed.

For portfolio context, see the repository README and community session summary.